

Adam Cote

ACote23@WGU.edu / 701-509-0624

Cybersecurity professional with hands-on experience building and operating a Security GRC program in a HIPAA-regulated healthcare environment, including security incident investigation and response documentation, risk assessments, third-party risk management, security policy and runbook authorship, MDR alert triage, and multi-framework compliance operations. Built and led the security function as sole practitioner across an 11-site clinic network — owning the full incident lifecycle from triage through root cause analysis, corrective action tracking, and runbook improvement. Developed GenAI-augmented audit workflows to scale multi-client compliance assessments across ten organizations. Seeking to bring incident response ownership, GRC program execution, and a bias for follow-through to a cloud-first security team.

Professional Experience

IT Security and Infrastructure Administrator

February 2025 - Present

Northland Health Centers, Minot, ND

- Built and operate the organization's Security GRC function as sole practitioner across an 11-site Federally Qualified Health Center, supporting development, revision, and implementation of security and compliance policies, procedures, and metrics aligned to the HIPAA Security Rule and NIST CSF v2.0.
- Conducted an organization-wide HIPAA security risk assessment identifying critical vulnerabilities (cleartext credentials, absent MFA, flat network architecture, unencrypted PHI), produced a formal risk matrix with likelihood and impact scoring, and delivered a phased 0–7–30–90 day remediation roadmap to executive leadership - coordinating remediation efforts to completion.
- Established and maintain a third-party risk management program covering vendor intake, BAA verification, sub-processor mapping, DNS/SSL certificate transparency forensics for data-flow validation, and post-deployment forensic review - named engagements include Adobe Acrobat Sign, Automattic/Akismet, JotPsych, and Presort Plus, with formal compliance gap reports issued where BAA coverage or PHI handling was deficient.
- Maintain the organizational risk register and provide guidance on exception requests and non-standard software approvals, balancing operational need against HIPAA and security risk.
- Implemented, monitored, and continuously improved the HIPAA Security Awareness Program for ~80 users across 11 sites, designing scenario-based PHI training (26-slide deck), recurring security briefings ("Newsday Tuesday"), and blame-free phishing reporting workflows reinforced with real OCR enforcement case studies.
- Investigate, document, and remediate security incidents triaged from managed MDR and other security controls - including a six-month SSL VPN password spray campaign (271 unique passwords against 16 accounts) characterized through packet captures and Windows Security Event log analysis (4625, 4740, 4624), and a phishing investigation against a billing distribution list closed with documented no-IOC findings.
- Independently validated the MDR provider's external attack surface assessment, identifying 9 exposed firewall management interfaces vs. 4 reported and confirming that 2 devices reported as remediated remained publicly accessible — demonstrating third-party validation discipline beyond vendor-supplied reports.
- Designed and coordinated a controlled NTLM relay penetration test from guest wireless to PHI file servers, scoped with the managed SOC and validated through file-hash verification, providing concrete evidence of a network segmentation gap to drive remediation prioritization.
- Authored security policies, SOPs, and technical runbooks with change control, rollback procedures, and validation checklists - including phishing intake/triage, EHR password reset with compensating controls, BitLocker deployment, AD CS renewal, and Windows Event Forwarding configuration — establishing audit-defensible processes across endpoints, servers, mobile devices, and cloud services (M365 / Entra ID).

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Independent Compliance Consultant (Peer Engagements)

March 2026 - Present

Healthcare consortium, 10 federally qualified health centers; conducted on personal time

- Deliver multi-client compliance assessments to a 10-organization FQHC consortium, including HHS Section 504 / WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility audits and HIPAA Notice of Privacy Practices (NPP) compliance reviews, with formal gap reports citing regulatory authority and recommended remediation.
- Built custom audit tooling to scale assessments across multiple clients — including a Playwright + axe-core multi-viewport accessibility scanner with GenAI-orchestrated triage and automated report generation, delivering plain-language executive summaries and developer-facing technical appendices across ten organizations from a single repeatable workflow — and a PowerShell-based CIS Benchmark control-testing framework that generates per-machine audit spreadsheets and aggregated HTML compliance reports.
- Identified that 9 of 10 audited organizations were substantially deficient in NPP compliance and tracked relevant regulatory case law (e.g., Purl v. HHS vacatur) to ensure findings reflect current enforceable requirements rather than stale eCFR text.

Information Systems & OT Electronics Technician

January 2017 - October 2024

Liberty Oilfield Services, Mid-Rockies Region

- Deployed and maintained integrated IT/OT network and control systems across multi-site oilfield operations, including sensors, radios, satellite links, and data acquisition platforms, minimizing downtime through component-level diagnostics and repairs
- Maintained strict documentation, regulatory compliance, and change-control discipline across electronic and network system integrations

Tool Supervisor, Coordinator

October 2013 - January 2017

Thru Tubing Solutions, Minot, ND

Supervisor, Warehouse Dispatcher

September 2010 - October 2013

Pumpco Energy Services, Minot, ND

Airframe and Powerplant Mechanic (Crew Chief)

September 2006 - September 2010

United States Air Force, Minot AFB, ND

Certifications

SecurityX (Formerly CASP+), *CompTIA*

April 2026

Pentest+, *CompTIA*

March 2026

Cybersecurity Analyst+ (CySA+), *CompTIA*

September 2025

Security+ Certification, *CompTIA*

September 2025

Network+ Certification, *CompTIA*

October 2025

A+ Certification, *CompTIA*

April 2025

Pending Exams

CHPS (Certified in HIPAA Privacy and Security), *AHIMA*

May 2026

CISM (Exam Summer 2026), *ISACA*

Summer 2026

SecAI (Exam Summer 2026), *CompTIA*

July 2026

CISA (Exam Fall 2026), *ISACA*

Fall 2026

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Education

Master of Science in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance April 2026
Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT

Bachelor of Science in Aviation Maintenance Technology December 2022
Thomas Edison State University, Trenton, New Jersey

Associate in Science in Electronics Systems Engineering Technology December 2022
Thomas Edison State University, Trenton, New Jersey

Skills

GRC Frameworks & Regulations: HIPAA Privacy Rule, HIPAA Security Rule, HITECH, 42 CFR Part 2, NIST CSF v2.0, NIST 800-53 (familiarity), ISO 27001 (familiarity), SOC 2 (familiarity), PCI-DSS (familiarity), CIS Benchmarks, MITRE ATT&CK, HHS Section 504 / WCAG 2.1 AA

Risk & Compliance Operations: Risk register maintenance, risk assessment & scoring, third-party / vendor risk management, BAA review, audit evidence collection, remediation tracking, exception management, security policy & SOP development, incident response documentation, executive risk reporting

Security Operations: MDR alert triage, incident investigation, IR tabletop coordination, log analysis (Windows Security, Entra sign-in/audit), phishing triage, vulnerability validation, external attack surface review (Shodan)

Cloud & Identity: Microsoft 365, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Azure MFA, Active Directory, Group Policy, AD CS / PKI

Endpoint & Infrastructure: Windows Server 2019, Hyper-V, BitLocker, NinjaOne RMM, SonicWall firewalls, NPS/RADIUS, RRAS VPN, Windows Event Forwarding

Tooling & Scripting: PowerShell, Python, Wireshark, VirusTotal, ANY.RUN, Playwright + axe-core, GenAI workflow automation (LLM-orchestrated audit runbooks and report generation)

Healthcare Systems: NextGen EHR, FQHC operating environment, HIPAA-regulated clinical workflows